a minute, I remember thinking, *this is really two presidents he's talking about*.

The talks continued for a few more hours, but that night Ford came to my suite and said, "Look, this isn't gonna work."

Until this point, I had still thought there might be a way of working something out. Although I never envisioned him sharing in decisions and wouldn't have accepted it if that had been proposed to me, I thought there might be assignments he could handle that would take advantage of his experience and prestige as a former president.

But, when he came to my suite, he took himself out of consideration.

Because he was a former president, he said his advisors believed it would be appropriate for him to take on responsibilities beyond those normally given to a vice-president. But he said he knew from his own experience in the White House the country couldn't operate with two presidents.

For several days, I had expected Ford to be on the ticket and I hadn't given much thought to other candidates; now I had to choose a running mate and time was of the essence. The delegates were waiting for me at the Joe Louis Arena to announce my decision.

The obvious choice was George Bush. We had been through a competitive and sometimes rough primary battle, but I had always liked him personally and had a great respect for his abilities and breadth of experience; and I knew he had a lot of support within the party.

George and Barbara Bush were upstairs in the hotel. A few moments after Gerald Ford left my suite, I called Bush and said:

"George, it seems to me that the fellow who came the closest and got the next most votes for president ought to be the logical choice for vice-president. Will you take it?"